

Lesson 8. Grammar: Sequence of Tenses.

Topic: Medical education in the United Kingdom.



Sequence of Tenses

The sequence of tenses (known in [Latin](#) as *consecutio temporum*, and also known as agreement of tenses, succession of tenses and tense harmony) is a set of [grammatical](#) rules of a particular language, governing the [agreement](#) between the [tenses](#) of verbs in related [clauses](#) or [sentences](#). A typical context in which rules of sequence of tenses apply is that of [indirect speech](#). If, at some past time, someone spoke a sentence in a particular tense (say the present tense), and that act of speaking is now being reported, the tense used in the clause that corresponds to the words spoken may or may not be the same as the tense that was used by the original speaker.

- ❖ Sequence of tenses in its narrow sense refers to principles according to which the tenses of subordinate clauses are suited to the tenses of principal clauses.
- ❖ Sequence of tenses in its broad sense refers to principles according to which tenses in any discourse are suited to each other.

